

The Badge Outlived the Scare

Marking Displacement Into Unbadged Rooms After a Timesheet-Rounding Scare

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Background

A timesheet-rounding scare among casual tutors prompted a badge-tap-in rule for the marking-pool workroom in 2025. Two nearby rooms have no reader. Did the badge verify hours worked, or relocate the marking it logs?

Aims

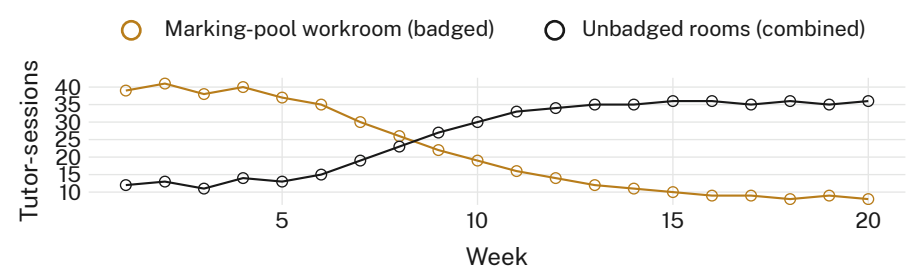
- Test whether badge-tap-room occupancy fell because marking moved, not because it stopped
- Identify a step-change in unbadged-room occupancy at the rollout date
- Establish whether the badge-tap requirement was ever reviewed once the scare had passed

Methods

- 46 casual tutors · 1 badged + 2 unbadged marking rooms · door-reader and manual sign-in logs · 20-week window spanning rollout
- Interrupted time-series on weekly room occupancy, badged vs. pooled unbadged rooms
- Rollout date and review-trigger criteria pre-registered against the access-control system's install log

Results

Badge-tap-room occupancy fell steadily after rollout while the two unbadged rooms absorbed the difference almost exactly. No policy review was logged in the twelve months that followed.



Marking-pool workroom occupancy fell from a pre-rollout mean of 39 tutor-sessions per week to 8 by week 20, while the two unbadged comparison rooms rose from a combined 13 to 36 over the same window, crossing in the week of 23 March 2026 ($n = 46$ tutors).

Discussion & conclusions

The badge logged fewer marking hours in the room it audited, not because less marking occurred but because tutors relocated to rooms with no reader installed. The scare that justified the rule lapsed within the reporting quarter; the reader did not. Displacement appears roughly conservative: the marking the badge stopped recording surfaces, almost session for session, next door. No decommissioning trigger exists in the current access-control policy, and none was invoked once the rounding audit closed. Next: a sunset clause tied to the finding that prompted the rollout, not to a fixed review date.

References

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Occupancy logged from badge-reader and sign-in timestamps only; no tutor-level marking output retained.

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